



The Financial Initiative

Dear Honorable Rosilicie Ochoa Bogh and Members of the California State Legislature,

On behalf of The Financial Initiative, I am writing to express our strong support for Senate Bill 1147, which provides local educational agencies the flexibility to offer a comprehensive, year-long integrated personal finance course to fulfill high school graduation requirements.

The Financial Initiative is an internationally affiliated nonprofit organization dedicated to helping students learn the fundamentals of finance early on, no matter where they live. To these young students, time is the single greatest edge they possess compared to older generations. Whether it is leveraging the power of compound interest, developing the foresight to avoid predatory debt, or building the disciplined habits required for long-term wealth, starting early fundamentally changes the trajectory of a young person's life.

We proudly support SB 1147 because of its direct alignment with our mission. While California's existing mandate for a standalone one-semester personal finance course is an excellent starting point, financial literacy is deeply nuanced and shouldn't be rushed. By allowing schools the option to weave these critical life skills into a rigorous, year-long integrated curriculum through combining it with economics or business, students are given the necessary time to absorb and apply these concepts in a meaningful manner.

Furthermore, by ensuring this year-long option satisfies both the standalone mandate and the economics requirement, SB 1147 removes the friction schools would otherwise face. It empowers them to treat financial literacy with the academic weight it deserves, providing a more robust framework for students to practice and retain these skills for the real world.

For these reasons, The Financial Initiative is proud to support SB 1147 and respectfully requests your "Aye" vote as this vital bill moves through the legislative process.

Sincerely,

Praneel Sharma

The Financial Initiative

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